

2024 年全国大学生英语竞赛决赛(C 类)

2024 National English Competition for College Students

(Level C-Final)

(Total: 150 marks Time: 120 minutes)

Part I Listening Comprehension (30 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **five** short conversations. Each conversation will be read only **once**. At the end of each conversation, one question will be asked, and you have **fifteen seconds** to read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

1. A. At an embassy.
B. At an airport.
C. At an interview.
D. At an information booth.
2. A. A journalist.
B. An entrepreneur.
C. An interviewer.
D. A media consultant.
3. A. Extra cash bonus.
B. Accumulated vacation time.
C. The compensation they request.
D. Regular overtime payment.
4. A. Her boss is too strict.
B. Her husband is short-tempered.
C. She is too busy with work.
D. She has to do an operation now.
5. A. Career plan of the woman.
B. Health of the man's brother.
C. Importance of saving time.
D. Necessity of keeping quiet.

Section B (10 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **two** long conversations. Each conversation will be read only **once**. At the end of each conversation, there will be a **one-minute** pause. During the pause, read the questions and make your answers on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the center.*

Conversation One

*Listen to the conversation. Then read the **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer according to what you hear. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

6. Why does Jenny come to the information centre?
A. She needs to fill in the library form.
B. She is looking for a suitable part-time job.
C. She inquires about appropriate societies.
D. She wants to apply for a community college.

7. Which society is Jenny interested in joining?
 - A. Culture and language.
 - B. Health and fitness.
 - C. Music and Poems.
 - D. Cycling, rowing and swimming.
8. Where does Paul work?
 - A. In room A12.
 - B. In room A14.
 - C. In room C16.
 - D. In room C18.
9. Which sport does Jenny like most?
 - A. Cycling.
 - B. Rowing.
 - C. Running.
 - D. Swimming.
10. What do people do in the stall run by Sarah?
 - A. Introduce vegetarian food and life.
 - B. Keep fit through regular exercises.
 - C. Make models and do paper cutting.
 - D. Organise races and running events.

Conversation Two

*Listen to the conversation, and complete the sentences with one word according to what you hear. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

11. As the presenter introduced, Lily Williams and her husband gave up their careers and set about _____ their own business ten years ago.
12. Though often driven to tears by failure, Lily insists that neither she nor her husband is _____ any more.
13. In her book “*Breakout-Life Beyond The Corporation*”, Lily stated that her most important motive to start up new ventures was to have _____.
14. After they made the decision to leave the large company they worked for, Lily and her husband began to consider the most _____ issues, such as money and what business to start.
15. They finally chose to start a business that they had _____ in.

Section C (5 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **five** short news items. Each item will be read only **once**. After each item, there will be a **fifteen-second** pause. During the pause, read the question and the **four** choices marked **A**, **B**, **C** and **D**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

16. What did the new study find?
 - A. Lots of young adults were keen to experience VR.
 - B. Most retired people enjoyed using VR technology.
 - C. Lonely individuals took delight in experiencing VR.
 - D. VR technology was most effective in curing dementia.
17. How do polar bears cope with the climate change according to the research?
 - A. They stay on land to save energy.
 - B. They fight land animals for living space.
 - C. They burn as few calories as possible.

- D. They try to search for food on land.
18. How much oxygen does Europa produce according to the research data?
- A. 1,000 tone every 24 hours.
B. 2,000 tons every 24 hours
C. One million tone every day.
D. Two million tons every day.
19. Why do scientists propose Category 6 of hurricanes?
- A. There have appeared hurricanes unknown in 50 years.
B. The strongest tropical storms are getting even more powerful.
C. There are more and more ocean windstorms these days.
D. The traditional Saffir-Simpson scale is out of date.
20. What happened in American higher education in 2023?
- A. Many small colleges closed or combined with nearby schools.
B. Private colleges applied for more fund to cope with the economic crisis.
C. Community colleges were required to offer online degree programmes.
D. Overseas students had to suspend education and leave the country.

Section D (10 marks)

*In this section, you will hear **one** monologue. The monologue will be read **twice**. After listening, answer the questions using **not more than five words**. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.*

21. What is the simplest definition of ‘news’ in the talk?
22. How do TV news editors differentiate from newspaper editors in choosing stories?
23. What does the newspaper editors’ decision depend on when they choose what to report?
24. What must editors of a print newspaper keep an eye on besides their audience?
25. Which two areas of a print newspaper need editing most?



Part II Vocabulary & Grammar (15 marks)

*There are **15** incomplete sentences in this part. For each blank there are **four** choices marked **A, B, C** and **D**. Choose the one that best completes the sentence. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **answer sheet** with a single line through the centre.*

26. There was little we could do _____ registering a formal complaint to the car factory.
A. beyond B. into C. over D. without
27. In _____ of value for money, this is the best watch I have ever bought.
A. light B. regards C. sense D. terms
28. I can't sleep at night these days—I think I should _____ the amount of coffee I drink.
A. cut off B. cut in C. cut down on D. cut off from
29. The employers had better _____ the problem with the workers or they'll go on strike.
A. get away B. turn out C. set off D. sort out
30. There is absolutely no _____ that sort of behaviour, no matter what they said to you.
A. reason for B. excuse for C. explanation on D. impact on
31. Students are accepted to most universities solely _____ their entrance examination grades.
A. on the basis of B. with regard to C. for the sake of D. in relation to

32. You should include a covering letter _____ your CV when you send an application.
 A. on account of B. in addition to
 C. on behalf of D. in face of
33. It is extremely important that all of you _____ here on time tomorrow morning.
 A. to be B. be C. will be D. must be
34. Mr. Anderson seems totally unaware of the suffering _____ outside his own comfortable little world.
 A. which being B. what is
 C. that being D. there is
35. Volcanoes are divided _____ three main groups, based on their shape and the type of materials they _____.
 A. by; are made up of B. for; made up
 C. into; are made of D. through; made of
36. _____ mainly for his invention of the telephone, Alexander G. Bell devoted his life to _____ the deaf.
 A. As is remembered; help B. Though remembered; helping
 C. To be remembered; helping D. While being remembered; help
37. You don't want to be late for the party, do you? So let's _____ and leave right now.
 A. seek the limelight B. face the music
 C. play it safe D. run the show
38. Jackie goes jogging so often that he needs a new pair of _____ every six months.
 A. bats B. clubs C. gloves D. trainers
39. —My opinion is that the essay has some weaknesses. The scope of research is limited. Besides, fundamentally, the circumstances China is facing are different from the German case.
 —_____ In principle, the Chinese cases and the German cases are similar.
 A. Is that true? B. I don't think so.
 C. No problem. D. Who can tell?
40. —Last night I saw a strange-looking man behind our school.
 —Were you frightened?
 —_____ I felt rather sorry for him. He was barefoot.
 A. Far from it. B. Not very well.
 C. I don't know. D. Yeah, he shouldn't do that.

Part III Cloze (10 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in the blanks with the correct forms of 5 words out of the 7 given in the box. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

recommend; find; injure; mark; effect; conclude; look after

The Mozart effect is the use of music to reduce stress or depression, encourage relaxation, activate the body and improve memory. The use of music can also improve listening disorders and other conditions such as dyslexia, attention deficit disorder and autism, and even help with physical ailments and (41) _____.

The power of the music of Mozart has been investigated by numerous researchers over the years. In the 1950s, Dr. Alfred Tomatis began his well-known study into the role of music in the development of speech and communication in children. His (42) _____ led to Mozart's violin concertos and symphonies being used in centres around the world to treat children with speech problems. In more recent years, the effect of Mozart's music on epilepsy has been the subject of research carried out in the United Kingdom.

As Mozart wrote more than 600 major compositions during his lifetime, selecting the most suitable piece of music can be difficult. From the work of Dr. Tomatis, we know that music containing higher frequencies stimulates the auditory system in the brain. For relaxation, slower music with lower frequencies is more (43) _____. Varying key and tempo to achieve a variety of auditory, physical and emotional responses is the key to success.

Although different types of music have different effects on listeners, some generalisations can be made. To encourage imagination, stimulating music such as folk music and marches is (44) _____. Other researchers suggest that listening to slow Baroque music, by composers like Bach and Corelli, can optimise learning.

There is little in the way of (45) _____ evidence to suggest that music can actually increase intelligence. Nevertheless, a popular study showed that students who listened to Mozart prior to taking an intelligence test scored higher marks than those who didn't.

Section B (5 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in each blank with **one** word in one of the following **three** ways: according to the context, by using the correct form of the given word, or by using the given letter(s) of the word. Remember to write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

It may be difficult to imagine a movie theatre today that wouldn't be cool on a hot day, but air-conditioned comfort was once a big bonus for your ticket price. In fact, circulating conditioned air, fed into the theatre from the ceiling and taken out from the floor level, was first (46) inst _____ in 1922 at Graumann's Metropolitan Theatre in Los Angeles, California.

Willis Carrier invented a mechanical air conditioner in 1911. With the development of Freons in the early 1930s, air-conditioning systems began to appear in office buildings, hospitals, apartments, trains, and buses. Freons are highly efficient refrigerant gases that are carbon compounds containing fluorine and chlorine or bromine. The refrigerant becomes a liquid and gives (47) _____ heat when it is compressed. When the pressure is removed, it becomes a gas that absorbs heat.

In the air-cooling cycle, warm humid air is drawn from the room and forced over the cooling coil that contains the refrigerant. The warm air gives up its heat to the refrigerant. The refrigerant fluid vaporizes as it absorbs the heat in the air. The (48) _____ (moist) in the cooled air condenses on fins over the coils, and the water runs down the fins and drains out. The cooled dehumidified air is blown back into the room.

Meanwhile, the vaporized and now much warmer refrigerant moves to the compressor. The compressor pumps it under pressure to the condenser coils. Here the heat in the refrigerant is (49) _____ (transfer) outside by a fan. The refrigerant is recirculated to the cooling coil as a liquid to continue the cooling process. A thermostat controls the compressor motor, turning it off when the room temperature is cool enough and (50) re _____ it as the temperature begins to rise. As for the movie-going audience, all they have to do is enjoy the movie as the air conditioner keeps them cool.



Part IV Reading Comprehension (30 marks)

There are **three** passages in this part. Each passage is followed by several questions. Respond to the questions using information from the passage. Remember to write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

Section A (10 marks)

Questions 51—55 are based on the following passage.

Is it really true that women can't read maps? How is it that women can chat for hours, while men never listen to a word they say? When it comes to the differences between men and women, it is impossible to tell where truth ends and stereotyping begins. However, there is one difference that is

certainly true. (51) _____ Can it be true that being a man is bad for you?

One big difference between men and women comes from the hormones testosterone and oestrogen. Men have more of the former and women more of the latter. Testosterone is the hormone that makes men look the way they are. It creates body hair and muscle. It also causes baldness, but a little hair loss means small punishment for a stronger, faster body. Except for one other thing. Testosterone does strange things to men's minds.



(52) _____ It is no accident that men enjoy physical, extreme sports. Men are also more likely to be involved in violent behaviour. They seek conflict where women try to create harmony. All this means that men find themselves in dangerous situations much more than women, and they are more likely to die in accidents, for example, than women are. On the other hand, having higher oestrogen levels is definitely an advantage for women. Oestrogen has many positive effects, but one in particular is that it protects the heart. So women are much less likely to suffer from heart disease.

But can we really blame nature for everything? Surely, we're not just victims of biology, forced to play out a script that has already been written? There are, after all, many men who do live to a ripe old age, and live healthy independent lives into their nineties. How have they managed to live so well? There are other things happening here. (53) _____ Men are much more likely to live unhealthily: drinking alcohol and smoking are two male habits that can shorten life expectancy. The situation isn't helped by the male enthusiasm for red meat and fried food.

(54) _____ They are much more aware of health and illness, and are used to regular visits to the doctor. Men, by contrast, often avoid seeking professional medical advice until the last minute, which is not to be advised.

(55) _____ Being a man is much more dangerous. So when your father, brother or son is suffering from a nasty bout of man-flu, remember to give him all the care he needs. Sometimes, it's hard to be a man!

Questions 51—55

Choose from the sentences A—G the one which best fits each gap of 51—55. There are **two extra** sentences which you do not need to use.

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|--|
| <p>A. All this evidence suggests that the traditional idea of women as the weaker sex is outdated.</p> <p>B. It is now believed that testosterone makes men take risks.</p> <p>C. Do you take more after your mother or father in personality?</p> <p>D. Across the world, in all societies and at all income levels, women live longer than men, why?</p> <p>E. By contrast, women tend to take care of themselves better.</p> <p>F. Ultimately, people need to monitor themselves, how they feel and how well they perform.</p> <p>G. If men do live shorter lives than women, it could be that lifestyle is a factor.</p> |
|--|

Section B (10 marks)

Questions 56—60 are based on the following passage.

In 2007 Jeremy Marie set out to live his dream of going around the world by the means of transport he calls 'the most social', in other words, hitchhiking. His preparations included planning a route and setting up his website. He travels light, but he carries a backpack which contains the essential things for his journey.

Before they saw him off, his friends warned him that it would be difficult, even impossible to hitchhike around the world. If he had listened to them, he would never have left his home country, France.

For most people, hitchhiking means hanging around at the side of the road and holding your thumb out. This does not always work, as Jeremy quickly found out. In some countries people consider it rude.

In other places, if there is no traffic, a hitchhiker will wait for hours. So Jeremy often goes to petrol stations to look for lifts, or tries to catch a driver's attention as he slows down or stops at traffic lights or crossroads.

The most difficult countries to find a lift were Italy, where he often had to wait for hours, and the USA, where hitchhiking is actually against the law in many states. The easiest places to get a lift, Jeremy says, were the Sudan and Syria. Generally he had little trouble in Africa. If the country is poor, people seem more open to picking up strangers. Also if there are few tourists, a foreigner like Jeremy will make local people curious. Most of the time, if he is in the right place, one of the first ten vehicles will stop.

For Jeremy hitchhiking is a means of transport which helps him to understand the world a little better. He says, 'If you are in a small place with a person, it encourages you to talk to them and you learn from this conversation. If you hitchhike, you can meet all kinds of people who may be rich, poor or unemployed. Everyone has their own opinion about their country, which they are keen to share with a curious traveller.'

In some countries, where there are almost no private cars, Jeremy has travelled in trucks, on little home-made vehicles, on tractors and even on a donkey. Often he meets other foreigners who are exploring the same country. In Italy, an Australian who rescued him from a long wait in the rain took him on a tour of the country in his camper van for several days!

If there is a road, there will usually be vehicles. But what happens if there is no road and he has to cross a lake, a sea or an ocean? The most difficult lifts were those which needed a boat. It sometimes took him weeks to hitch a ride on a boat. He couldn't get a lift unless the captain agreed.

After travelling in over a thousand vehicles, Jeremy is still on the road, and still excited at every new lift he gets. Each time a driver pulls up and invites him into his vehicle, it is the start of a new adventure.

Questions 56—60

Answer the following questions with the information given in the passage.

56. What did Jeremy take on his hitchhiking journey around the world?
57. How does Jeremy usually hitchhike?
58. Which place is most friendly to hitchhikers according to Jeremy?
59. What does hitchhiking mean for Jeremy?
60. When could Jeremy hitch a ride on a boat?

Section C (10 marks)

Questions 61—65 are based on the following passage.

The first zoo is believed to have been in Egypt in around 3500 BC. Early collections of animals on display often belonged to royalty. Until the late twentieth century, the main purpose of zoos was for entertainment. They existed to give people the chance to see animals they could not see in the wild. In 1959, famous wildlife expert Gerald Durrell opened the first zoo which put conservation of animals first.

Nowadays zoos' aims are: conservation, education, entertainment, in that order. Modern zoos try to get a balance between providing safe, comfortable homes for the animals and opportunities for visitors to see animals in natural surroundings. Zoos now share their knowledge and support each other. The World Association for Zoos and Aquariums (WAZA) works to educate people about animal welfare and conservation. It also helps to coordinate breeding programmes.

From the 1990s, zoos began to see their main role as saving the most threatened species. Each zoo focuses on a small number of species. The Siberian tiger and the orangutan are two species that have been



saved through breeding programmes run by zoos. For example, in 2005 there were between 331 and 393 Siberian tigers in the Russian Far East. By 2015, there were 562. The tigers were helped to breed under the Species Survival Plan of the Association of Zoos and Aquariums (AZA). Often the aim is to reintroduce endangered species into their natural habitats. In Indonesia, Borneo Orangutan Rescue teaches orangutans how to live in the wild. When they are ready, they are: taken to protected forests to live naturally.

Now that we have a better understanding of animals, zoos try to recreate natural habitats of animals as accurately as possible. For example, polar bears live in a plain, white open space. Zoos try to provide ‘enrichment’ for the animals to improve their wellbeing. This includes climbing frames, feeding puzzles, unusual objects and different types of food. It allows animals to behave in a normal way, such as scratching, climbing, digging and solving problems. Another type of enrichment is mixing up types of animal that would naturally mix in the wild. Colchester Zoo in England has a ‘kingdom of the wild’ paddock where several species live together. They have found positive changes to the behaviour of these animals as a result.



Different types of technology are used to help create natural environments for animals. In Indianapolis Zoo in the United States, for example, there is a ‘functional forest’ called the Hutan Trail, a series of towers and cables 20 metres above the ground. This allows the orangutans to swing around the zoo as they would swing around the forest in their native Indonesia.

Likewise, technology has been used to engage the public more with the animals. In many zoos there are webcams in some enclosures so visitors can keep up with their favourite animals between visits to the zoo.

Zoos have moved on over the last few decades. They now play an important role in protecting animals and in making people more aware of the importance of animals. Zoos have made people aware that animals should not be over-hunted and that they play an important role in the ecology of the planet and in helping to maintain the balance of nature.

Questions 61—65

Complete the summary below with information from the passage, using **no more than three** words for each blank.

In the past, zoos existed mainly for (61) _____. The first zoo to focus on (62) _____ was started by wildlife expert Gerald Durrel. Since the 1990s, a number of zoos have introduced programmes which aim to breed threatened animals and return them to their (63) _____. But prior to that the animals have to learn (64) _____ in the wild. Zoos offer animals enrichment by making it challenging for them to find their food, providing them with climbing equipment, and even mixing them with other species. They play an important role in helping maintain the (65) _____.



Part V Translation (15 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into Chinese. Write the answer on the **answer sheet**.

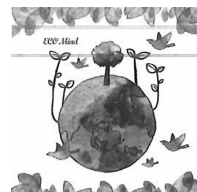
66. It is said that the world’s population will reach about nine billion in 2050. That’s around two billion more than now. When you consider that there are around one billion people in the world already living in difficult times due to a lack of food, then the future is more worrying. Also, with the increasing difficulty facing the world due to human numbers and climate change, many wonder how we will feed this larger population without destroying the planet.

Section B (10 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into English. Write the answer on the **answer sheet**.

67. “更理性地消费”指的是秉持绿色理念,做出对环境友好的选择。这些选择可能包括家庭节能、

以最环保的方式旅游、巧妙通勤、减少肉类消费、支持本地产品与服务、选购环保材料,以及学会重复利用。但更理性消费还意味着要确定商品值得购买,即使该商品有环保标志。一旦我们树立了环保理念与道德观念,掌握了如何才能做出对环境友好的选择,下一步就是“更理性地消费”。



Part VI IQ Test (10 marks)

There are **five** IQ Test questions in this part. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

68. What is a ‘seminar’?

- A. a unique idea
- B. an informal gathering
- C. an academic meeting
- D. a memorable occasion

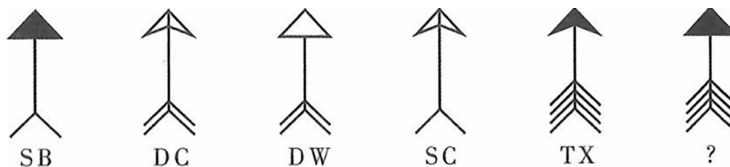


69. Some like me hot, others prefer me cold, yet I come in countless forms. What am I?

70. How old would a person born in 50 BC be on their birthday in 50 AD?

71. I bought 4 pencils at 2p each, 5 pens at 8p each and 8 notepads and 16 stamps. Though I cannot remember the prices of the last two items, I can confidently question a bill of £2.10. Why is this? (Answer can be in Chinese.)

72. Which code matches the shape or pattern given at the end of the line?



A. SX

B. TC

C. TB

D. DX

E. TW

Part VII Error Correction (10 marks)

There are **10** errors altogether in the following passage. The errors are: missing words, unnecessary words and wrong words. Please correct them as follows: for a missing word, mark its position with a symbol “^” and write it; for an unnecessary word, cross it out with the symbol “\”; for a wrong word, underline it and write the correct word. An example of how to correct the error is provided below. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

For example:

One of my favorite writers are Charlotte Bronte. She was born in the early nineteenth century when women had far fewer opportunities ^ they have now. She lived in a small village in Yorkshire and she took \ a great pleasure in walking on the moors near her home.

is
than
a



Many people—parents and educators—feel that children should take part in team sports so as to learn which to work as part of a group. However,

73. _____

other people think that making children to participate in sports for this reason may not be such a great idea. Because playing in a team can teach children how to cooperate others, making them do this when they don't want to can actually damage their self-confidence.

74. _____
75. _____
76. _____

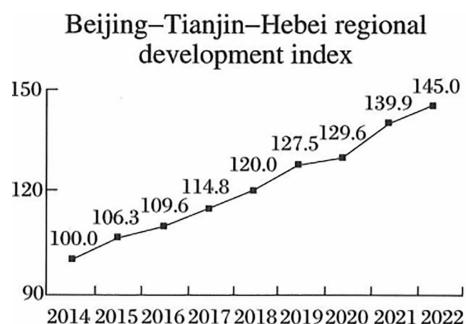
There are many other ways to get kid to work with each other, so it seems a bit silly to force them to play team sports when they will rather be doing something else. Some young people live for the thrill and exciting of being part of a team whereas others do not like it of all. Children Shouldn't be forced to join a team in cases they start hating sports...all kinds of sports. Clearly, no one wants that to happen. Wouldn't it be worse to let children decide for themselves?

77. _____
78. _____
79. _____
80. _____
81. _____
82. _____

Part VIII Writing (30 marks)

Section A (10 marks)

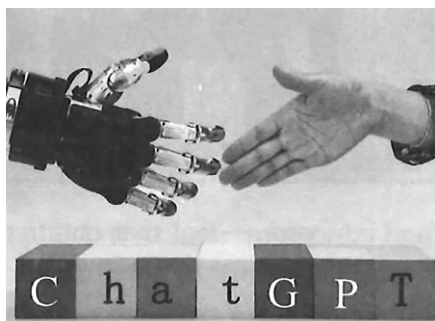
83. Write a **120-word** report on the Beijing-Tianjin-Hebei regional development index through the years of 2014 to 2022.



Write the report on the **answer sheet**.

Section B (20 marks)

84. ChatGPT, a chatbot developed by artificial intelligence research laboratory Open AI, has gained a lot of attention in and outside the tech world. Interacting in a conversational way, it is capable of writing emails, scripts, academic papers, even poems, song lyrics or computer code. Is it beneficial to your life? How will you apply it to your study?



Write a **180-word** essay to express your opinions. Write the essay on the **answer sheet**.